

Booking the Second-Opinion Call.

Read traffic. Use real numbers. Show, don't tell.

Session 27 · Friday 5 June 2026 · Marketing Sweet

IN THIS TOOLKIT

- 01** The second-opinion frame
- 02** Specific numbers > round numbers
- 03** The traffic matrix
- 04** Show-don't-tell close
- 05** Daily reference card

DON'T

"Your provider isn't doing a great job — you should switch to us."

WHAT THE BUYER HEARS

"You wasted your money. Now defend yourself."
Buyer's defences fire. Conversation over.

DO

"Some areas are working really well. Whether you change or not — completely up to you. Want a 10-minute unbiased read?"

WHAT THE BUYER HEARS

"This person respects what I've done. No pressure. Worth a look." Defences down. Meeting booked.

THE THREE MOVES INSIDE THE LINE

- Acknowledge** what's working — the buyer doesn't have to defend it
- Signal competence** — "I've already read the data"
- Lower the stakes** — "no commitment, just looking"

02 · SPECIFICS

Use the Real Number on the Screen

The percentage is the credibility. Don't round it.

VAGUE

**"Your traffic is
down about 20%"**

Sounds like a guess.



SPECIFIC

**"Your traffic is down
23.5% this month."**

Sounds like someone who looked.

THE LINE — USE VERBATIM

"Don't be too alarmed, but your traffic has gone down by 23.5% this month — which is probably to do with your ranking slipping. I understand you're doing something. Can I have 15 minutes of your time next week to show this on the software?"

THREE MOVES IN ONE LINE

Real number	"23.5%" — exact, from the screen
Calm tone	"don't be too alarmed" — defuses panic
Bounded ask	"15 minutes next week" — easy to grant

03 · READ THE VOLUME

The Traffic Matrix

Pick the right pitch for the profile in front of you.

Low traffic <300 visits / month	Site is largely invisible. Campaign isn't producing.	<i>"Your site is barely getting seen — 15 minutes to show what's missing?"</i>
Mid + decreasing 300–1,000 with a drop	Provider eased off, rankings slipped, or algorithm shift hit.	<i>"Traffic's down 23.5% — that's a ranking slip. Worth 15 minutes?"</i>
Healthy traffic, poor site 1,000+ with weak UX	SEO works. Site lets traffic through. Conversion is the leak.	<i>"SEO is doing its job — site isn't catching what it sends."</i>
High traffic, strong campaign 1,000+ with momentum	Already in good hands. Don't displace — position as second opinion.	<i>"You're doing better than most. I'd still love a 10-minute read."</i>

TRACK IT

Print this page. Tick the profile every time it comes up. After two weeks you'll know exactly where your team is sharp and where it's underprepared.

04 · THE CLOSE

Show, Don't Tell

The most reliable booking line in the session.

THE LINE

"I've got a lot to show you — about 5 to 10 minutes' worth. It's much easier if I show you rather than talk on the phone, because it can get confusing. When's a quiet half-hour next week?"

WHY IT WORKS

It's true. SEO data does look like noise when described out loud, and obvious on screen.

It puts the buyer in receive mode. Being shown is easier than being talked at.

It implies a screen. Screen = meeting. Meeting = the close.

It sounds reasonable. Not pushy. Not desperate. Just helpful.

THE PRICING JAB · USE SPARINGLY

Deliberately under-quote what you think they're spending. "Looks like you're paying around \$300/month — I'd step that up." If they're actually paying \$1,000, they'll correct you — and the correction is the meeting.

ONLY ON confident, invested buyers. Never on tentative small-business owners.

05 · WHEN THEY SAY NO

The Soft Frame

Open the door — don't crash through.

CARRY THIS LINE

"Whether you go with us or someone else — you need to look at this."

WHY IT WORKS

It puts the rep on the buyer's side of the table. Implicit message: the rep cares about the buyer's outcome more than the rep's commission.

THE RULE

Only use it when it's true. Sometimes the buyer's current provider IS fine. Saying so builds credibility that compounds.

WHEN THEY PUSH BACK

1. Step back. Don't argue. "Totally hear you."
2. Probe gently. "Is it the timing, or the current setup?" — find out what "fine" actually means.
3. Offer the email. Send the traffic %, the ranking position, the page-two keyword. No pitch.
4. Bounce. "If anything in there is interesting, grab 10 minutes next week? Sound fair?"
5. Move on. If still no, log them in the 50% bucket and follow up in two weeks (Session 24).

REFERENCE

Daily Card · Keep By the Phone

The whole session on one page.

BEFORE THE CALL

- ◆ Open SEM Rush. Have the traffic number, % change, and one ranking position ready.
- ◆ Know which traffic profile they fall into (see Page 4).
- ◆ Pick the matching pitch line.

THE FRAME

- ◆ "Some areas are going really well."
- ◆ "Whether you change or not — completely up to you."
- ◆ "I'd love to give you a 10-minute unbiased second opinion."

THE NUMBER

- ◆ Use the exact percentage from the screen. Never round.
- ◆ Pair it with a calm hypothesis: "probably a ranking slip."
- ◆ Bound the ask: "15 minutes next week."

THE CLOSE

- ◆ "It's much easier if I show you — when's a quiet half-hour?"
- ◆ If they hesitate: send the email, ask for 10 minutes next week.
- ◆ Don't argue. Open the door. Move on.

IF YOU CAN'T SAY SOMETHING TRUE AND SPECIFIC IN 90 SECONDS · YOU HAVEN'T EARNED THE MEETING